Noach 5784

Parshas Noach. All the בעלי מדרש have said numerous times that everything needs to have מזל, even a ספר תורה בהיכל has to have מזל. The מזל about חומש is that the first pasuk in every parsha has millions of מדרשים on it, and the later pesukim in the parsha are not discussed as intensively. So in פרשת נח, guess who we're going to talk about? Not what you expected, we're going to talk about אברהם אבינו.

It says at the very end of the parsha that אברהם אבינו comes from תרח (11:27): תֶּרַח הוֹלִיד אֶת אַבְרָם אֶת נָחוֹר וְאֶת הָרָן. Who is הרן? הרן was אברהם אבינו's brother. It also mentions that הרן died in אור כשדים (11:28) וַיָּמָת הָרָן עַל פְּנֵי תֶּרַח אָבִיו. Rashi says that הרן died before his father died. Why did he die?

Another question is that one of our famous stories about אברהם אבינו is אור כשדים. Where is that in the תורה? Ain't nowhere in the תורה. It's in this Rashi at the end of נח. אברהם אבינו would not bow down to נמרוד הרשע ימח שמו. So Nimrod said, "I'm throwing you into the fire." But as he was going into the fire and was being saved, they asked הרן, "Who are you with? Are you with נמרוד or are you with אברם?" He said, "Let me see what happens." When he saw that אברם was saved, he said, "I'm with אברם". They threw him into the fire and he wasn't saved as he was doing it שלא לשמה. אברהם אבינו did it לשמה. So the whole אור כשדים מדרש, upon which we start our whole narrative of אברהם אבינו, who he was and what he represented, which was מסירות נפש and קידוש שם שמים, is in Rashi at the end of נח. Not in לך לך, certainly not in וירא or חיי שרה. So now we know who אברם is. Thank you Rashi, and thank you the pasuk, because Rashi is explaining the pasuk, of course. But it's buried here. It's buried here for a very simple reason.

Every nation in the world glorifies itself on its independence. America has July 4th, the French have their day, July 14th. The Mexicans have José de Martín. Every nation, even the Russians ימח שמם, even the Ukrainians, certainly the French, everybody is always proud of their heritage, of their independence and their Bastille Day, their starting out as great nations. And what do we do? We start out with, as we say about the haggadah, מתחילין בגנות ומסיימין בשבח. So we say מִתְּחִלָּה עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה הָיוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ - We started out little. We never claim our independence. We say הקדוש ברוך הוא took us out of מצרים, no one else. הקדוש ברוך הוא is the one who's responsible for our independence, not us. In exactly the same way, אברהם אבינו's great brilliance, fantastic מסירות נפש to start off our history as a nation is also buried. It's very hidden. We have to go and uncover it and search for it. Like everything else in this world, אמת is hidden; שקר is all over the place. Our אמת is buried there. We have to look for it, and when we look for it we'll actually appreciate it more because we have to put in the effort to find it.

אברהם אבינו's glorious beginning is hidden at the end of פרשת נח. Hidden at the end of the parsha where nobody is looking. Everybody's looking at how wonderful נח is. And yet אברהם אבינו surpassed him in so many ways. We're not בני נח, we're בני אברהם יצחק ויעקב. And בעזרת השם, in that זכות, may we be זוכה to ביאת גואל צדק במהרה בימינו אמן.

https://youtu.be/ryPbr4pLYQA